

TCS NQT 2026

Complete Study Timetable & Preparation Guide

(For a Beginner in Python | December 2026 Exam Target)

Prepared for	TCS NQT Aspirant (Beginner in Python)
Plan Start Date	18 July 2026 (Saturday)
Target Exam Window	December 2026
Daily Study Commitment	8 hours/day
Total Duration	~20 weeks (approx. 140 days)
Sections Covered	Numerical Ability, Verbal Ability, Reasoning Ability, Advanced Quant & Reasoning, Advanced Coding (Python)

This plan is built around the current TCS NQT pattern: an integrated single test with a mandatory **Foundation section** (Numerical, Verbal, Reasoning Ability) and an **Advanced section** (Advanced Quant & Reasoning + Advanced Coding, Python supported) which decides Ninja / Digital / Prime bands. There is no negative marking. Since your Python knowledge is currently limited, extra weeks are dedicated to building it from scratch before moving to coding-round practice.

1. TCS NQT Exam Pattern (Reference)

Section	Part	Duration	Approx. Questions
Numerical Ability	Foundation	25 min	20
Verbal Ability	Foundation	~26 min	25 (Sentence Completion, Passage Recall, Email Writing)
Reasoning Ability	Foundation	25 min	20
Advanced Quantitative + Advanced Reasoning	Advanced	25 min (shared)	~30 (shared)
Advanced Coding	Advanced	90 min	2-3 problems (Python/C/C++/Java)

Key notes: No negative marking. No going back to previous questions once you click Next. Foundation must be cleared to get Advanced evaluated. Advanced section decides Digital/Prime band eligibility. Since your goal is Digital/Prime (better roles), treat the Advanced Coding round as high priority.

2. Study Plan at a Glance (5 Phases)

Phase	Duration	Dates (2026)	Main Focus
Phase 1	4 weeks	18 Jul - 14 Aug	Python fundamentals from zero + Numerical Ability basics
Phase 2	5 weeks	15 Aug - 18 Sep	Python DS & problem solving + Verbal + Reasoning Ability
Phase 3	5 weeks	19 Sep - 23 Oct	Advanced Coding practice + Advanced Quant/Reasoning
Phase 4	4 weeks	24 Oct - 20 Nov	Full mock tests, previous year papers, weak-area fixing
Phase 5	2-3 weeks	21 Nov - 11 Dec	Final revision, speed & accuracy, last mocks, light days before exam

3. Daily 8-Hour Study Structure (Templates)

Use the matching template depending on which Phase you are in. Take a 5-10 min break every hour; a longer 45-60 min break after the 4th hour (lunch).

Template A - Phase 1 & 2 (Foundation Building)

Time Block	Hours	Activity
Session 1	2 hrs	Python concept learning (video/docs) + write small code yourself
Session 2	2 hrs	Python hands-on practice problems (HackerRank/GfG - easy level)
Session 3	2 hrs	Aptitude: Numerical / Verbal / Reasoning Ability concept + examples
Session 4	1.5 hrs	Aptitude practice questions (topic-wise, timed)
Session 5	0.5 hr	Revise today's notes + note down mistakes/doubts

Template B - Phase 3 (Advanced Practice)

Time Block	Hours	Activity
Session 1	3 hrs	DSA topic learning + coding problems on that topic (Python)
Session 2	2 hrs	Advanced Quant + Advanced Reasoning practice (timed sets)
Session 3	2 hrs	Mixed coding practice (previous TCS NQT coding questions)
Session 4	1 hr	Review wrong answers, redo them without looking at solution

Template C - Phase 4 & 5 (Mock Test Mode)

Time Block	Hours	Activity
Session 1	3.2 hrs	One full-length TCS NQT mock test (attempt like real exam, timed, no pause)
Session 2	2.5 hrs	Detailed analysis: redo every wrong/skipped question, note error pattern
Session 3	1.5 hrs	Targeted revision of the weakest topic found in analysis
Session 4	0.8 hr	Quick revision of formulas/coding patterns sheet

4. Phase 1 (18 Jul - 14 Aug): Python from Zero + Numerical Basics

Week	Python Topics	Aptitude Topics (Numerical Ability)
Wk 1 18-24 Jul	Installing Python, variables, data types, input/output, operators, if-else	Number system, HCF & LCM, Simplification, Divisibility rules
Wk 2 25-31 Jul	Loops (for/while), lists, tuples, strings & string methods	Percentages, Profit & Loss, Ratio & Proportion
Wk 3 1-7 Aug	Dictionaries, sets, functions, scope, recursion basics	Averages, Time & Work, Time-Speed-Distance
Wk 4 8-14 Aug	File handling, exception handling, list/dict comprehensions, basic OOP (class, object)	Simple & Compound Interest, Mixtures & Allegations, quick revision of Wk1-3

Goal by end of Phase 1: you should be able to read a problem statement and write a working Python function using loops, conditionals, lists and strings without help.

5. Phase 2 (15 Aug - 18 Sep): Python Problem-Solving + Verbal & Reasoning

Week	Python / DSA Topics	Verbal & Reasoning Ability
Wk 5 15-21 Aug	OOP in depth (inheritance, polymorphism), modules	Verbal: Vocabulary building, synonyms/antonyms, sentence completion
Wk 6 22-28 Aug	Time & space complexity basics, arrays/lists problem patterns	Verbal: Reading comprehension, passage recall practice
Wk 7 29 Aug-4 Sep	Searching (linear, binary) & sorting (bubble, selection, insertion) with code	Reasoning: Blood relations, Direction sense, Coding-Decoding
Wk 8 5-11 Sep	Strings & pattern problems, 2D lists/matrices	Reasoning: Series (number/letter), Syllogisms, Seating arrangement
Wk 9 12-18 Sep	Recursion problems, basic stacks/queues using lists	Verbal: Email writing practice; Reasoning: Puzzles, Data sufficiency; full revision

6. Phase 3 (19 Sep - 23 Oct): Advanced Coding + Advanced Quant/Reasoning

Week	Coding Practice Focus	Advanced Quant & Reasoning
Wk 10 19-25 Sep	Easy-level coding questions on HackerRank/GfG (arrays, strings, loops) - Python	Permutation & Combination, Probability
Wk 11 26 Sep-2 Oct	Medium pattern & logic-building problems, dictionaries/sets usage	Progressions (AP/GP), Probability advanced, Data Interpretation
Wk 12 3-9 Oct	Recursion-based & basic DP-style problems (fibonacci, factorial variants)	Geometry & Mensuration basics, Statistics
Wk 13 10-16 Oct	Actual previous-year TCS NQT coding questions (timed, 90-min mock)	Advanced Reasoning: Critical reasoning, Pseudo-code based questions
Wk 14 17-23 Oct	Mixed coding round mock (2-3 questions in 90 min) + revise weak patterns	Mixed advanced aptitude timed sets + revision

7. Phase 4 (24 Oct - 20 Nov): Full Mock Tests & Weak-Area Repair

From this phase, stop learning new topics. Each week = minimum 3 full-length mock tests + 4 days of targeted revision based on mock analysis. Maintain an 'error log' notebook: every question you get wrong, write down why (concept gap / silly mistake / time pressure).

Week	Focus
Wk 15 (24-30 Oct)	3 full mocks + revise Numerical & Verbal weak topics
Wk 16 (31 Oct-6 Nov)	3 full mocks + revise Reasoning & Advanced Reasoning weak topics
Wk 17 (7-13 Nov)	3 full mocks + revise Advanced Quant weak topics
Wk 18 (14-20 Nov)	3-4 full mocks + revise Coding round weak patterns, redo all past wrong codes

8. Phase 5 (21 Nov - 11 Dec): Final Revision

Week	Focus
Wk 19 (21-27 Nov)	2-3 full mocks + revise formula sheet & coding patterns sheet daily
Wk 20 (28 Nov-4 Dec)	1-2 full mocks + light revision, sleep well, avoid new/hard topics
Final days (5-11 Dec)	Only quick revision (2-3 hrs/day), rest well, keep confidence high; check exam admit card/instructions

9. Complete List of Concepts to Study

A. Python (from zero to interview-ready)

- Basics: variables, data types, type casting, operators, input/output
- Control flow: if-elif-else, for loop, while loop, break/continue
- Data structures: list, tuple, set, dictionary and their built-in methods
- Strings: slicing, formatting, common string methods, palindrome/pattern problems
- Functions: parameters, default args, *args/**kwargs, recursion, lambda
- OOP: class, object, constructor, inheritance, polymorphism, encapsulation
- Exception handling: try/except/finally, custom exceptions
- File handling: read/write files
- Time & space complexity (Big-O) - basic understanding
- Searching & Sorting: linear search, binary search, bubble/selection/insertion sort
- Basic Data Structures for coding round: arrays/lists, strings, stacks, queues, basic recursion, simple DP (factorial, fibonacci, basic memoization)

B. Numerical Ability

- Number System, HCF & LCM, Divisibility, Numbers & Decimal Fractions
- Percentages, Profit & Loss, Simple & Compound Interest
- Ratio & Proportion, Mixtures & Allegations
- Time & Work, Pipes & Cisterns
- Time, Speed & Distance (trains, boats & streams)
- Averages, Ages problems
- Permutation & Combination, Probability
- Progressions (AP/GP), Geometry & Mensuration, Statistics, Data Interpretation

C. Verbal Ability

- Vocabulary: synonyms, antonyms, one-word substitution
- Sentence completion / fill in the blanks
- Grammar: tenses, articles, prepositions, error spotting
- Reading comprehension & passage recall (memory-based questions)
- Professional email writing (formal tone, structure, clarity)

D. Reasoning Ability (Foundation + Advanced)

- Blood relations, Direction sense, Coding-Decoding
- Number/Letter/Alphanumeric series
- Syllogisms, Statement & conclusion, Statement & assumption
- Seating arrangement (linear & circular), Puzzles
- Data sufficiency, Critical/logical reasoning

- Pseudo-code based reasoning questions (advanced section)

10. Free Resources - Where to Study

Python (Free)

Resource	What it covers	Link
Python.org official tutorial	Complete beginner-friendly official docs	docs.python.org/3/tutorial
CS50P (Harvard, edX/YouTube)	Full free Python course with exercises	cs50.harvard.edu/python (also on YouTube: 'CS50P')
freeCodeCamp Python Course	Full beginner-to-intermediate video course	youtube.com - search 'freeCodeCamp Python Full Course'
W3Schools Python	Quick topic-wise reference with try-it editor	w3schools.com/python
Programiz Python	Beginner tutorials with online compiler	programiz.com/python-programming
GeeksforGeeks Python	Concepts + practice problems	geeksforgeeks.org/python-programming-language

Aptitude - Numerical, Verbal, Reasoning (Free)

Resource	What it covers	Link
IndiaBIX	Topic-wise theory + practice with solutions	indiabix.com
GeeksforGeeks Aptitude	Quant + reasoning theory & practice	geeksforgeeks.org/aptitude-gq
PrepInsta (free section)	TCS NQT specific topic-wise material	prepinsta.com/tcs-nqt
Testbook (free content)	Aptitude & reasoning practice sets	testbook.com
Vocabulary.com	Free vocabulary building & quizzes	vocabulary.com

Coding Practice (Free)

Resource	What it covers	Link
HackerRank	Python practice problems, beginner to intermediate	hackerrank.com
GeeksforGeeks Practice	DSA problems + articles	geeksforgeeks.org/practice
LeetCode (free tier)	Coding problems, easy level for beginners	leetcode.com
Coding Ninjas Studio (free)	Structured DSA problems	naukri.com/code360
CodeChef	Beginner-friendly practice + contests	codechef.com

11. Where to Take Free Mock Tests

Platform	What you get	Link
TCS iON official practice	Official-style sample/practice test (check current availability)	tcsion.com
GeeksforGeeks TCS NQT Series	TCS NQT specific mock/practice tests	geeksforgeeks.org (search 'TCS NQT test series')
PrepInsta	Free TCS NQT mock tests + previous year papers	prepinsta.com/tcs-nqt
Testbook	Free TCS NQT mock tests, PYQs, sample papers	testbook.com/tcs-nqt
IndiaBIX	Section-wise free practice tests	indiabix.com
HackerRank	Timed coding practice contests (skill building)	hackerrank.com/contests

Tip: In Phase 4 & 5, always attempt mocks in one sitting, exactly like the real exam (no pausing, no switching tabs), since TCS NQT locks each question/section once you move ahead.

12. Quick Tips for Success

- Keep one 'formula & pattern' notebook - revise it daily in the last 10 minutes of study.
- Since there's no negative marking, never leave a question blank - attempt everything, even a guess.
- Practice under time pressure from Week 10 onwards, not just in Phase 4 - speed matters as much as accuracy.
- For coding round: focus on writing clean, working code fast rather than optimal/complex solutions.
- Sleep 7+ hours daily throughout the plan - 8 hours of study only works well with proper rest.
- Re-check official TCS NQT registration dates and exact exam pattern closer to your exam (patterns can be updated).

All the best for your TCS NQT exam!

Note: Exam pattern/dates are based on publicly available information as of July 2026 and may change - please cross-check with the official TCS NQT / TCS iON notification closer to your exam date.